

The Australian Government works with governments across the globe to support Australia's domestic forestry interests, promote sustainable forest management, combat [illegal logging](#) and its associated trade, and advance Australia's trade and market access interests.

Our department in particular collaborates with Australia's regional neighbours and key trading partners to shape and manage key forestry matters through bilateral relationships and [multilateral fora](#).

The Department has a long-standing relationship with Papua New Guinea on forestry cooperation and on 16 February 2023, Australia and Papua New Guinea re-signed a Memorandum of Understanding to continue this relationship. The Memorandum of Understanding outlines areas of forestry cooperation, including sustainable forest management, combatting illegal logging and its associated trade and forest certification. Key outcomes under the Memorandum of Understanding for forestry in Australia and Papua New Guinea include promoting:

- an understanding of each Partner's national forestry policy and legislative frameworks
- trade in legal timber and timber products
- the sustainable management of forests
- effective governance in forest industries
- investment in forest industries
- investment in carbon projects
- investment in non-timber forest products
- investment in plantation forestry
- capacity building, information sharing and investment opportunities in carbon projects.

In addition, the memorandum of understanding includes objectives to identify:

- opportunities for collaboration on forest research, training and information sharing activities
- areas for cooperation on forestry and interrelated emerging issues through multilateral forestry fora.

Australia – Papua New Guinea forestry cooperation bilateral meetings are held approximately every 12-18 months alternately in Australia and PNG.

Papua New Guinea Forestry Twinning Program

The Australian Government is working with the PNG Government to support sustainable forest management in PNG.

The PNG Forestry Twinning Program is a partnership between our department and the PNG Forest Authority (PNGFA). The program delivers on the objectives of the 2023 Memorandum of Understanding on forest cooperation. We are providing technical support and knowledge sharing on plantation development and governance. This is supported through face-to-face workshops, training and short-term deployments.

The program is funded by the Department of Foreign Affairs and Trade's [PNG Institutional Partnerships Program](#).

Australia and Indonesia have shared cooperation on forestry matters since the establishment of the Australia-Indonesia Working Group on Agriculture, Food and Forestry Cooperation (WGAFFC) in 2007.

In January 2022, the WGAFFC was superseded following the signing of a new Agriculture Cooperation Memorandum of Understanding by the Agriculture Ministers from Indonesia and Australia, and no longer extends to forestry matters.

In August 2025, the Australian Department of Agriculture, Fisheries and Forestry and the Ministry of Forestry of the Republic of Indonesia signed a cooperation arrangement on Forestry. This cooperation arrangement establishes an ad-hoc Australia-Indonesia Working Group on Forestry to enhance consultation and cooperation between the participants on forestry matters of mutual interest, including trade and regional engagement.

Bilateral forestry meetings with Indonesia are typically held annually, alternately in Australia and Indonesia.

The Malaysia-Australia Agricultural Cooperation Working Group (MAACWG) met in Putra Jaya, Malaysia in August 2007, and agreed to expand the role of the working group to include forestry matters.

Under the MAACWG, the Forestry and Timber Sub-Working Group has been established to cooperate on activities in support of sustainable forest management, including:

- recognising the need to address illegal logging and promote further action on this matter through multilateral processes
- exploring cooperation in forest management certification and chain of custody schemes
- identifying and exploring areas of collaboration and cooperation on the international stage that both countries are engaged.

The MAACWG meetings are held approximately every two years, alternately in Australia and Malaysia.

In 1997, the then Department of Primary Industries and Energy (now the Department of Agriculture, Fisheries and Forestry) and the Korean Forestry Administration (now the Korea Forest Service) signed an arrangement which establishes the Korea-Australia Forestry Cooperative Committee (KAFCC).

The KAFCC is an effective medium for developing closer cooperation between Australia and the Republic of Korea on forestry matters such as research, investment and trade and focuses on the key areas of:

- information on investment opportunities in Australian plantations and export opportunities for Australian forest products to Korea
- developing an understanding of the requirements for countries seeking to achieve forest certification

- arranging an exchange of forestry professionals between Korea and Australia.

The KAFCC meets approximately every two years, alternately in Australia and Korea.

The Australia-China Agricultural Cooperation Agreement (ACACA) promotes cooperation on forestry matters and enhancing trade opportunities between the two countries. ACACA was signed in 1984 to:

- enhance cooperation in a wide range of agricultural sectors
- develop agricultural trading relationships
- provide a forum for the exchange of scientific information.

Australia and China meet under the agreement to discuss forestry matters supported by the Joint Working Group on Forestry (JWGF) that was established in 1988.

To complement this agreement and to guide cooperation between Australia and China on forestry matters, the Australian and Chinese Governments signed a memorandum of understanding in 2009 concerning cooperation in forestry and combating illegal logging and associated trade. The memorandum of understanding provides a framework to support Australian and Chinese cooperation in the following areas:

- enhancing global and regional efforts to combat illegal logging and associated trade
- promoting sustainable forest management
- facilitating a mutual understanding in the Asia-Pacific region of the requirements for legality verification of internationally traded timber
- encouraging trade in timber and wood products from legally harvested and sustainable managed forests
- enhancing forest law enforcement and governance, and sharing information on forest certification schemes
- building capacity of forest management professionals and experts in the Asia-Pacific region to implement sustainable forest management practices in the region including preventing illegal logging.

The Illegal Logging Working Group (ILWG) exists under the JWGF to conduct the objectives of the memorandum of understanding. The group had its first meeting immediately following the JWGF meeting on 1 September 2010 and now meets in conjunction with the JWGF meetings.

JWGF generally meet every three years, alternately in Australia and China.

Australia and New Zealand continue to strengthen their long-standing cooperation on forestry matters.

In 2012, Australia and New Zealand signed a formal bilateral Arrangement on Combating Illegal Logging and Promoting Sustainable Forest Management. Since its expiry in 2015, Australia and New Zealand have continued to share an ongoing commitment to collaborate in combatting illegal logging and promoting sustainable forest management, including:

- ongoing bilateral cooperation against the illegal logging trade of timber and its impact on jobs, economies, and the environment

- building capacity of government and industry to manage forests sustainably and promote systems to verify the legality of timber and wood products in Australia, New Zealand, and the wider Asia Pacific region.

Australia and New Zealand meet formally on an 'as needs' basis, often in the margins of larger multilateral meetings.

Australia and the United States have established regular bilateral engagement on forests matters, including:

- sharing information to combat illegal logging and associated trade under respective legal frameworks
- cooperating to strengthen respective timber legality frameworks
- supporting global forests initiatives
- promoting the sustainable use of timber
- collaborating in multilateral forests fora
- sharing information on domestic forestry initiatives and developments.

Australia and the United States typically hold in-person bilateral forestry discussions in the US following on from annual UN Forum on Forests sessions, which take place in New York, as well as engaging elsewhere as needed.

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/agriculture-land/forestry/international/regional>